

Hey!
I'm Hrishikesh Kakade

I'm a Founding Product Designer with 4+ years of experience taking products from 0 to 1, and scaling them with strong UX foundations. I am comfortable operating in ambiguity and can rapidly absorb into new domains, operating at the intersection of product strategy and design. I specialize in design systems, scalable architecture, and translating complex problems into intuitive, high impact digital experiences, working closely with stakeholders, product and engineering teams to turn ideas into structured, execution-ready solutions.

Contact Details

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Hrishikesh Kakade

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Skills

Product Design & Strategy

- **UX Strategy & Systems Thinking**
- **0 to 1 Product Design**
- **Interaction Design**
- **Information Architecture**
- **User Research and Usability Testing**
- **Design Systems & Component Libraries**

Execution

- **Wireframing & Prototyping**
- **Responsive Web & Mobile Design**
- **Developer Handoff & Design Documentation**
- **Working knowledge of HTML, CSS, and frontend implementation constraints**
- **AI-Assisted Design**

Collaboration

- **Cross-functional Leadership**
- **Stakeholder Communication**
- **Design Mentorship**

Tools

- **Figma (Advanced, Design Systems)**
- **Adobe Creative Suite (Photoshop, Illustrator)**
- **AI-assisted tools for research, prototyping, and workflow automation**
- **Rhinoceros 3D, Blender, Keyshot, AutoCAD**

Work Experience

Founding Product Designer - Astuto.ai

Sep 2023 - Present

- Built and scaled a design system compatible with tailwind CSS & Material UI, used across the product, enabling higher design-to-dev efficiency.
- Led end-to-end design for multiple high-stakes product initiatives, partnering closely with founders and collaboration with PMs and engineering from discovery through execution.
- Managed and mentored a team of 3 designers, improving design quality and execution speed.
- Conducted user research and validation cycles to align roadmap decisions with user needs.
- Established Astuto's early stage brand identity. Establishing a consistent visual and interaction language across product and marketing touchpoints.

UI/UX Designer - Kristal.AI

May 2023 - Sep 2023

- Overhauled the UI and interaction design of Kristal.AI's client app and web portal, significantly improving usability and visual design.
- Designed an improved and optimized onboarding workflow, That reduced drop-offs by 40% and led to better data collection.
- Created responsive dev ready component library to help get faster and cleaner dev turnaround
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to deliver high-fidelity app demos, instrumental in securing UAE trade licensing approval.

Associate UI/UX Designer - Kristal.AI

October 2021 - May 2023

- Designed end-to-end experiences for B2B, B2C, and B2B2C financial products.
- Identified friction points through research and usability testing, turning insights into actionable design improvements.
- Developed high-fidelity interactive prototypes for stakeholder and user validation, accelerating communication and feedback cycles.

Graphic Designer - Young India's Parliament *(Freelance)*

March 2020 - June 2020

- Curated social media posts and designed deliverables for a youth parliament & educational org.

Education

B.Des, Product Design - Symbiosis Institute of Design

June 2017 - Aug 2021

Senior Secondary Education (PCM) - Army Public School, Pune

June 2015 - April 2017